

Peer-Review Report

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Peer-Review Report of:

Peer Review Report of Submission MP2018.878

by Kuper & Bott

Final Decision: ACCEPTED

Joseph Hilgard

Department of Psychology, Illinois State University

Jens Agerström

Department of Psychology, Linnaeus University

Moritz Heene

Department of Psychology, Ludwig Maximilian University

Rickard Carlsson

Department of Psychology, Linnaeus University

This is a peer review report that summarizes the editorial process of then submission MP.2018.878. The full editorial history, including the reviews and decision letters, can be accessed on the OSF project page: <https://doi.org/10.17605/OSF.IO/H2RX7>. On 2018-04-30 Kuper and Bott submitted a meta-analysis entitled “Has the evidence for moral licensing been inflated by publication bias” to Meta-Psychology. I (Carlsson) assigned myself as action editor. After concluding that the submission fit the aims and scope of the journal, I invited Hilgard and Heene (both experts in Meta-analysis) and Jens Agerström (expert in moral psychology) to invite it. I also circulated it on social media for a round of open peer review (no one contributed). I considered whether to invite the authors of the previous meta-analysis that the article builds on, but decided against it. This paper isn’t a commentary on their work but a clear incremental contribution building upon it.

All three reviewers and myself were very positive towards the manuscript, but also found revision crucial. Hilgard and Heene provided helpful suggestions for how to strengthen the statistical part of the paper, whereas Agerström focused his review on how to improve the theoretical and conceptual part of it. In their revision, the authors carefully attended to the issues raised by the reviewers and either addressed them directly through changes in the manuscript, or by carefully responding to the reviewer comment. It is my opinion that they greatly improved their manuscript in several ways. In particular, when attending to a point raised by Hilgard regarding the possible lack of independence of the coded effects, the results, and to some extent the conclusions, changed in their revised ver-

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sion. As they stated in the cover letter “Specifically, the evidence for publication bias is less consistent across methods and the effect size reductions using the 3-PSM are less extreme”. On 2019-01-07, I accepted their manuscript for publication in Meta-Psychology, and sent it to copy-editing and statistical reproduction. Because the analysis fits my own research area well, I decided to conduct the statistical reproduction myself. I was able to reproduce the results without any problems. I also replicated the simulations with highly similar results. I recommended the authors to do some minor changes to the R-scripts to improve ease of use.

Author contribution

Hilgard, Agerström and Heene reviewed the submission. Carlsson verified the reproducibility of the analyses. Carlsson edited the submission and summarized the editorial process into this report. Authors are listed in random order with editor last.

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